The Noble Six-Syllable Vidyā-Mantra

Āryaṣaḍakṣaravidyā · Toh 917 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཡི་གེ་དྲུག་པའི་རིག་སྔགས

The Noble Six-Syllable Vidyā-Mantra, known in Sanskrit as Ārya Ṣaḍakṣaravidyā and in Tibetan as Pakpa Yigé Drukpé Rikngak, is a brief sūtra-style scripture centered on a protective spell. It opens at Śrāvastī, where the Buddha tells the venerable Ānanda that this "queen of six-syllable vidyā-mantras" has been proclaimed by six perfectly complete buddhas, by the four guardians of the world, and by the twenty-eight great generals of the yakṣas. He urges Ānanda to take it up, hold it, recite it, and master it. The Buddha then gives the mantra itself and explains that it brings relief to those afflicted by pain and other troubles. The work is Toh 917 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, scriptures that preserve and teach powerful incantations for protection and healing.

In the language of India: ārya ṣaḍakṣara vidyā. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Six-Syllable Vidyā-Mantra.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, the six-syllable vidyā-mantra has been spoken by the six perfectly complete buddhas, by the four guardians of the world, and by the twenty-eight great generals of the yakṣas. Ānanda, take up this queen of six-syllable vidyā-mantras! Hold it! Recite it! Master it completely!

tadyathā dantile kantile daṇḍimati madhumati maraṇḍe koraṇḍe drāviti kośāri chaṭaje dudumati ketumati cudundhe kauṭadānte tahurare enanige hutabahuni

"Ānanda, this is the six-syllable vidyā-mantra. It is for one who is afflicted by pain in the head, pain in the eyes, pain in the ears, pain in the teeth, pain in the nose, pain in the tongue, pain in the heart, pain in the stomach, pain in the back, pain in the sides, pain in the urinary tract, pain in the shins, pain in the feet, pain in the limbs, pain in the minor limbs, indigestion, swelling, obstruction in the womb, disorders arising from wind, disorders arising from bile, disorders arising from phlegm, disorders arising from their combination, violent fever, fever that recurs every day, every second day, every third day,

and every fourth day, fleeting fever, daytime fever, and nighttime fever. When, by this six-syllable vidyā-mantra, protection, shelter, care, and guarding have been given, pacification and well-being brought about, punishment warded off, weapons warded off, poison neutralized, sprinkling with water performed, and binding with thread performed, if anyone should transgress against this, Ānanda, I have not seen, in the world with its gods, its māras, and its Brahmās, among beings with their śramaṇas and brahmins, or in the world with its gods, humans, and asuras, anyone whose head would not split into seven pieces like the blossom cluster of the arjaka tree.

tadyathā aṇḍare paṇḍare karate keyūre bhūtaṃgame bhūtagahe bhūtaprakṣite bhūtayasmarayani priyāvati tejavati yaśovati girīṇini śariṇini May I be safe from all fears and all harms! svāhā"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the vidyā-mantra called The Noble Six-Syllable.

Translator's Notes

• The term chad pa, glossed in the house glossary as "annihilation," here stands in a list of protective effects beside "weapons warded off." It has therefore been rendered in its ordinary sense of "punishment" (Skt. daṇḍa). The phrase "the arjaka's dog pa" is taken as the blossom cluster of the arjaka tree. This follows the familiar Sanskrit image of a head splitting like an arjaka flower cluster (arjakasyeva mañjarī).

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.